



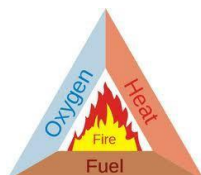
SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Ref:	049	Author:	D Bibby	Date:	07.02.2024
Topic:	THE FIRE TRIANGLE				

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

Let us talk about what makes a fire and what we can do to prevent one. Fire can be compared to a triangle. Three sides are necessary to make a triangle and three ingredients are necessary to cause a fire. These are heat, air and fuel.

If any one of these three sides is missing, there can be no fire.



HEAT:

Heat, the first side of the fire triangle, can come from many sources. It can be generated by sparks from welding operations, discarded cigarette butts, electrical shorts, frayed wiring, friction from power tools, and hot exhaust pipes.

FUEL:

Fuel, the second side of the fire triangle, may be liquid, such as petrol or solvents; a solid, such as paper or wood scraps; or a gas, such as propane.

AIR:

Air, the third side of the fire triangle, contains oxygen which is necessary to sustain a fire. This is one side of the triangle we cannot do much about. Air is usually present. Heat, fuel, and air must be in the proper proportion for a fire to occur. It is possible to have these three ingredients without causing a fire. For example, there may not be enough heat or air to ignite the fuel and cause it to burn.

ELIMINATING THE TRIANGLE

Let us talk about what we can do to prevent the fire triangle from forming. Remember that if you remove any one of the three ingredients, you will prevent or extinguish the fire. We can help prevent fires by doing the following:

- Maintaining a neat and clean work area, thus preventing an accumulation of rubbish.
- Putting oily or paint-soaked rags in covered metal containers.
- Observing all "No Smoking" signs.
- Keeping all combustible materials away from furnaces or other sources of ignition.
- Reporting any fire hazards which includes electrical hazards, which are the source of many fires.
- Arranging cold weather heating devices so that tarps will not blow into them.

**WHEN YOU KNOW THE ANGLES**

When you know the angles, it is easier to prevent and control fires. Remember the fire triangle: heat, air, and fuel. When you find these three ingredients present, take heed. A fire could be in the making.

Discussion Points

Are you happy where the fire extinguishers are located?

Is there any fire hazards around that you have seen today?